

Akhilesh Kakolu Ramarao

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RESEARCH AREAS

Computational Linguistics, Computational Morphology, Language Revitalization

EMPLOYMENT

2021– **Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf**

Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter, Department of English Language and Linguistics

- Teaching Computational Linguistics courses for Bachelor and Masters of Arts students
- Setup phonetics laboratory
- Maintainer of Slamlab server, hosting multiple services

2019–20 **Civicalab**

Natural Language Processing (NLP) Researcher

- Worked on building Language Platform for Assamese language that includes - Optical Character Recognition for Assamese, Machine Translation system for English and Assamese, Assamese keyboard, and creation of parallel corpora for English and Assamese

2017–19 **Skit.ai**

Software Engineer

- Involved in designing and developing end-to-end speech and natural language processing A.I. systems for automating customer care systems

2017 **Ramco Systems**

Software Engineer

- Prime developer in designing and developing a chatbot for Human Resource (HR) system

EDUCATION

Ph.D (ongoing)

General Linguistics, Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf, Germany
Advisors: Prof. Dr. Kevin Tang and Dr. Dinah Baer-Henney

M.A.	General Linguistics, Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf, Germany, 2022-2024 Thesis Title: Modeling irregular morphological patterns in Spanish verbs using transformers Advisors: Dr. Dinah Baer-Henney and Prof. Dr. Kevin Tang
B.Engg.	Automobile Engineering, Dayanand Sagar College of Engineering, India, 2012-2016

PUBLICATIONS

Conference Proceedings

- submitted **Kakolu Ramarao, A., Tang, K., Petersen, W., Bear-Henney, D.** Probing Character-level Transformers for the Spanish L-shaped Morpheme. Preprint:
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2608.03452>
- 2026 **Kakolu Ramarao, A.** Keyboards for the Endangered Idu Mishmi Language. In *Proceedings of the SIGUL 2026 Joint Workshop with ELE, EURALI, and DCLRL: Towards Inclusivity and Equality: Language Resources and Technologies for Under-Resourced and Endangered Languages at LREC 2026*, 49–54. Palma de Mallorca, Spain: ELRA Language Resources Association. <http://lrec-conf.org/proceedings/lrec2026/workshops/sigul/2026.sigul-i.o.pdf>
- 2026 **Kakolu Ramarao, A., Tang K. & Baer-Henney D.** Character-aware Transformers Learn an Irregular Morphological Pattern Yet None Generalize Like Humans. In *Proceedings of the 15th Workshop on Cognitive Modeling and Computational Linguistics (CMCL) at LREC 2026*, 74–85. Palma de Mallorca, Spain: ELRA Language Resources Association.
<http://lrec-conf.org/proceedings/lrec2026/workshops/cmcl/2026.cmcl-i.o.pdf>
🏆 Honorary Mention Award
- 2025 **Kakolu Ramarao, A., Tang K. & Baer-Henney D.** Frequency matters: Modeling irregular morphological patterns in Spanish with Transformers. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025, pages 4474–4489*, Vienna, Austria. Association for Computational Linguistics. <https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2025.findings-acl.230>
- accepted Merchant R., **Kakolu Ramarao A.** & Tang K. Connecting the Persian-speaking world through transliteration. *3rd North American Conference on Iranian Linguistics*. Preprint:
<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2502.20047>
- 2024 **Kakolu Ramarao, A., Petersen, W., Stein, A., Stein, E., & Xia, H.** KlarTextCoders at StaGE: Automatic Statement Annotations for German Easy Language. In *Proceedings of GermEval 2024 Shared Task on Statement Segmentation in German Easy Language (StaGE)* (pp. 15–27), Vienna, Austria. Association for Computational Linguistics.
<https://aclanthology.org/2024.germeval-1.2>
- 2023 Jeong, C.*, Schmitz, D.*, **Kakolu Ramarao, A.***, Stein, A., & Tang, K. Linear discriminative learning: a competitive non-neural baseline for morphological inflection. In *Proceedings of the 20th SIGMORPHON Workshop on Computational Research in Phonetics, Phonology, and Morphology* (pp. 138–150). Association for Computational Linguistics.
<https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2023.sigmorphon-1.16>
- 2022 **Kakolu Ramarao, A., Zinova, Y., Tang, K., & van de Vijver, R.** HeiMorph at SIGMORPHON 2022 shared task on morphological acquisition trajectories. In *Proceedings of the 19th SIGMORPHON Workshop on Computational Research in Phonetics, Phonology, and Morphology* (pp. 236–239). Association for Computational Linguistics.
<https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2022.sigmorphon-1.24>

Journal Articles

- submitted **Kakolu Ramarao, A.**, Tang K. & Baer-Henney D. Transformers over-extend what humans underlearn: the case of Spanish L-shaped morpheme. Preprint:
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2507.21556>
- 2024 Muschalik, J., Schmitz, D., **Kakolu Ramarao, A.** *et al.* Typing /s/—morphology between the keys? *Reading and Writing* (2024). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11145-024-10586-9>

TALKS

Peer-reviewed Talks

- accepted “Bye-lingual: teaching first-language attrition through (dis)fluency markers in a research-based Seminar” at the 2nd Speech Patterns and (Dis)fluency Markers: Insights from Spoken Corpora, Bucharest, Romania. Co-authors: Pamela Villar González.
- accepted “Teaching Phonological Theory using Automatic Speech Recognition” at the 6th International Symposium on Applied Phonetics (ISAPh), Hiroshima, Japan. Co-authors: Erdin Mujezinović.
- 2024 “Community-driven Language Revitalization: Translating Children’s Literature in K’man Mishmi” at the International Conference on Language, Ecology and Culture 2024, NEILAC, Guwahati, India. Co-authors: Sakelu Chikro and Dr. Pamir Gogoi. [Slides](#)
- 2024 “KlarTextCoders at StaGE: Automatic Statement Annotations for German Easy Language” at the Konferenz zur Verarbeitung natürlicher Sprache (KONVENS) 2024, University of Vienna, Austria. Co-authors: Wiebke Petersen, Anna Sophia Stein, Emma Stein, and Hanxin Xia.
- 2024 “A computational approach to understanding the cognitive reality of morphomic patterns: the case of L-shaped morphemes in Spanish” at the Annual Meeting of Linguistics Association of Great Britain and Northern Ireland 2024, Newcastle University, United Kingdom. Co-authors: Kevin Tang and Dinah Baer-Henney. [Slides](#)
- 2024 “Acoustic Analysis of Vowels in Idu Mishmi” at the 27th Himalayan Languages Symposium, IIT Guwahati, India. Co-author: Pamir Gogoi.
- 2023 “From Zero to Terminal Hero” at the 32nd Tagung der Computerlinguistik-Studierenden (TaCoS), Heinrich Heine University, Düsseldorf, Germany. [Slides](#)
- 2023 “Machine Transliteration between two Persian Dialects - The Case of Farsi and Tajiki” at the 32nd Tagung der Computerlinguistik-Studierende (TaCoS), Düsseldorf, Germany. Co-authors: Rayyan Merchant and Kevin Tang.
- 2023 “Can Neural Networks learn human-like behavior when inflecting verbs? The case of Spanish” at the Five-Minute Linguist competition, Linguistic Society of America 97th Annual Meeting, Denver, Colorado, United States of America.
- 2023 “Modeling irregular morphological patterns using Transformers” at the HeiCAD Lightning Talks, Heinrich Heine University, Düsseldorf, Germany.

Invited Talks

- 2025 “Python for Linguists” at Christ University, Bengaluru, India. [Notebook](#)
- 2025 “AI in Our Lives: The Ethics of AI Assistants” at the Tag der Forschung 2025, Heinrich Heine University, Düsseldorf, Germany. [Slides](#)

- 2021 “Language Revitalization: A case of Idu Mishmi” at Microsoft Research India.
- 2021 “Language Revitalization” at Navana Tech.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Peer-reviewed Presentations

- 2024 **Kakolu Ramarao, A.**, & Stein, A. S. AnglistikVoices: an L2 English speech dataset for educational and technological advancement in speech technology. LabPhon 19, Hangyang University, Seoul, South Korea. [Poster](#)
- 2023 Muschalik, J., Schmitz, D., **Kakolu Ramarao, A.**, & Baer-Henney, D. Acoustic duration and typing timing - same, same... but different? Phonetics and Phonology in Europe 2023, Nijmegen, Netherlands.
- 2023 Tang, K., **Kakolu Ramarao, A.**, & Baer-Henney, D. Modeling irregular morphological patterns with recurrent neural network: the case of the L-shaped morpheme. In 13th Mediterranean Morphology Meeting, University of the Aegean, Greece.

Non-peer-reviewed Presentations

- 2024 **Kakolu Ramarao, A.**, Tang K. & Baer-Henney D. Frequency matters: Modeling irregular morphological patterns in Spanish with Transformers. In 63rd Association for Computational Linguistics, Vienna, Austria. [Poster](#)

TEACHING

Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf

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|-------------|---|
| Summer 2026 | Making Sense of Sound: Intro to Acoustic Analysis |
| Summer 2026 | Bye-lingual IV: when you speak two languages but start to lose vocabulary in both of them (co-teaching: Pamela Villar González) |
| Winter 2025 | Synthesizing speech |
| Summer 2025 | Academic Writing |
| Summer 2025 | Applied Phonology: Evaluating Voice Assistants (co-teaching: Erdin Mujezinović) |
| Winter 2024 | LLMs in Linguistic Research |
| Summer 2024 | Learning Inflection |
| Winter 2023 | Accent unplugged: Evaluating Voice assistants |
| Summer 2023 | Synthesizing speech |
| Winter 2022 | Language technology for Linguists with Internet of Things (IoT) |
| Winter 2022 | LaTeX for Linguists |
| Summer 2022 | Towards a career in language technology: linguistic annotation |
| Winter 2021 | Basic Skills in Digital Humanities |

SKILLS

Recent programming experience: Python, Bash, LaTeX, Scheme, Julia

Past programming experience: Haskell, Dart, JavaScript (AngularJS)

Frameworks: PyTorch, Flutter, Django

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL

Platforms: Arch linux, Ubuntu, MacOS

Cloud: AWS, GCP, High-performance computing (HPC)

Other technologies: Git, Docker, Neovim, Hugo, Jekyll, CI/CD

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- 2022 Hardware Grant. 20 × NVIDIA® Jetson™ Nano Developer Kits. NVIDIA Academic Hardware Grant, “FOSStering Digital Humanities through Accent Diversity & Conversational Devices”. Co-applicant: Kevin Tang
- 2022 Education Grant. €9,424. e-Learning support fund, Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf. “Interactive web-based review units for phonetics and phonology”. Co-applicant: Christopher Geissler and Kevin Tang
- 2022 **First prize** at the HHU Legal Hackathon, Heinrich-Heine-Universität. Team: Akhilesh Kakolu Ramarao, Phaedon Paschalis and Diana Schill
- 2022 **First prize** at the HeiCAD Lightning Talks, Heinrich-Heine-Universität

FIELDWORK

- 2020- **Idu Mishmi community**
Roing, Arunachal Pradesh, India
 - Built the first E-Dictionary for Idu Mishmi and English in the form of an offline mobile dictionary application. Press coverage: <https://arunachaltimes.in/index.php/2020/12/14/imcls-launches-mishmi-idu-dictionary-app/>
 - Developed the first Android mobile keyboard application for the Idu Mishmi orthography.
<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=org.idumishmi.keyboard>

CONSULTING

- 2020-2021 XRI Institute
- 2020-2021 Vrook

VOLUNTEERING

- 2021- **Idu Mishmi Cultural and Literary Society (IMCLS)**
Chief Coordinator

2021- **Lohit Youth Library Network**
Volunteer

WORKSHOP ORGANIZATION

- 2024 Language learning workshop in K'man Mishmi, Bamboosa Library, Tezu, Arunachal Pradesh, India. Co-organizers: Sakelu Chikro and Dr. Pamir Gogoi
- 2023 Translation Workshop: English to K'man Mishmi, Bamboosa Library, Tezu, Arunachal Pradesh, India
- 2022 LibreSlam - Free and Open Source (FOSS) for everybody workshop at Heinrich-Heine-Universität Düsseldorf. Co-organizers: Anna Stein and Kevin Tang.

DEMOS

- 2024 "Students as Researchers" at the Nacht der Wissenschaft, Shadowplatz, Düsseldorf, Germany
- 2022 "Role of linguistics in AI for social good" at the Nacht der Wissenschaft, Shadowplatz, Düsseldorf, Germany

LANGUAGES

English *Fluent*

Kannada *Fluent*

Hindi *Advanced*

German *Beginner (A1 level)*